

PARENT HANDBOOK FOR NexGen School for Early Life Foundations, LLC

TABLE OF CONTENTS

	Policy No.
Mission Statement	1
Nondiscrimination Policy	1.1
Welcome	2
School Hours of Operation	3
Licensing Information	4
Governmental Licensing Information	4.1
Accreditation Information	4.2
Enrollment	5
Tuition	6
Payment Schedule	6.1
Late Payments	6.2
Subsidized Care	6.3
Subsidized Fee Dues	6.4
Parent Orientation (<i>please see copy</i>)	6.5
Confidentiality	7
Social Media	7.1
Mandated Reporting of Suspected Child Abuse and Neglect	8
Parent Code of Conduct	9
Swearing/Cursing	9.1
Threatening of Staff, Parents or Children	9.2
Physical/Verbal Punishment of Your Children or Other Children	9.3
Smoking	9.4
Not Abiding by Safety Rules	9.5
Confrontational Interactions with Employees, Other Parents And associates of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations	9.6
Violating the Confidentiality Policy	9.7
Parents Right to Immediate Access	10
Dismissal	11
Withdraw	12
Court Orders Effecting Enrolled Children	13
Arrival Procedures	14
Notification of Absences	14.1
Agency's Right to Refuse Admission	14.2

Pick Up Procedures	15
Late Pick Up	15.1
Persons Appearing to Be Impaired by Drugs and/or Alcohol	15.2
Emergency/Alternate Pick-up Forms	15.3
Transportation	16
School Calendar	17
Emergency and Inclement Weather Closing Information	18
Curriculum Information	19
Daily Schedule of Activities	19.1
Class Assignments	19.2
Staff to Child Ratios	19.3
Nap/Rest Time	19.4
Educational/Personal Care Supplies	19.5
Birthday and Holiday Celebrations	19.6
Parent/Teacher Conferences/Communication	19.7
Graduation	19.8
School Payer	19.9
Discipline	20
Toys From Home	21
Dress Code	22
Children	22.1
Parents	22.2
Field Trips	23
Parents Participation/Volunteering/Information Updating	24
Fundraisers	24.1
Donations	24.2
Updating Account Information	24.3
Annual Surveys	24.4
Health and Safety	25
Pre-Enrollment Requirements	25.1
Children with Severe Allergies	25.2
Communicable Disease	25.3
Biting	25.4
Dispensing of Medication	25.5
Fire/Emergency Drills	25.6
Alternate Safe Location	25.7
Incident/Accident Reports	25.8
Foods Policy	25.9
Peanut-Free Policy	25.10
Firearms and Weapons Policy	25.11
Children with Specials Needs	25.12
Water Activities	25.13
Animals On School Grounds	25.14
"Gang Free Zone"	25.15
Physical Activities Outdoor Play	25.16

Health & Nutrition	26
Screen Time	26.1
Vision and Hearing	26.2
Dental	26.3
Sol Care	26.4
Developmental Milestone Checklists & Child Progress Monitoring	27
Staff Employment by Client's Policy	28
Policy Agency Contact Information	29
Tuition	30

NexGen School For Early Life Foundations

Policy: MISSION STATEMENT

POLICY NO.: 1

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations is “Dedicated to Developing Young Minds for A Better Future.”

POLICY: NONDISCRIMINATION

POLICY NO.: 1.1

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations operates using a nondiscrimination policy. Applications for enrollment and/or employment are accepted without regards to race, religion, color, sex, or national origin.

POLICY: WELCOME

POLICY NO.: 2

Welcome to NexGen School for Early Life Foundations Family! We are excited to include you and your family to ours. Our center is “**Dedicated to Building Young Minds for a Better Future.**” It is our goal to provide the best age appropriate curriculum possible.

Every day we will strive to provide a loving and structured environment to bring out the best in our children’s creative, educational, social, and physical development. Research has shown that these early years are critical in forming the basis for a successful, healthy, happy adult. We want to capitalize on this precious time and help children become the best they can be.

Our enrichment program offers our students the option to experience other areas of learning and growth. Classes in Fine Arts, Cooking For Kids, Self-Defense/Karate, Scrapbooking For Kids, Ballet, Dance and Gymnastics will be available to enrich the learning opportunities for the children at our school.

Working together, parents and staff can offer our children the best learning environment possible. We encourage all parents to participate in all of our school activities, help your child with homework and project assignments, and review their weekly lesson plans. Children will want to do better in school if their parents are involved and take an active role in their work.

Parents are also invited to help in the classroom, bring items of interest to the class, stop by to read a book etc... We appreciate all your help!

Thank you for choosing NexGen School for Early Life Foundations.
I am looking forward to a great year!

Sincerely,
Roman Robledo Jr., Owner
Rachel Lopez, Director

POLICY: School Hours of Operation

POLICY NO.: 3

Weekly Hours will be from 7:00 A.M. to 5:30 P.M. for Full-Time students, from 7:00 AM to 12:00 noon or from 12:00 noon to 5:30 PM for Half-Day Students, from 11:00 AM to 5:30 P.M. or 2:45 P.M. to 5:30 P.M. for Afterschool Students.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations is open year-round from January to December.

POLICY: LICENSING INFORMATION

POLICY NO.: 4

4.1 We are licensed by The Texas Department of Family and Protective Services.

Contact information for licensing are:

Phone numbers: 1-800-252-5400

956-421-4710

956-316-8275 Website: www.txchildcaresearch.org

4.2 Information regarding our current license is available on our school information board in the lobby.

POLICY: ENROLLMENT

POLICY NO.: 5

Enrollment at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations is open to children from infants to age 13. Enrollment shall be granted without regard to a child's race, color, creed, religion, national origin, gender, or disability; and without regard to a parent or guardian's race, color, creed, religion, national origin, gender, pregnancy or disability.

Parents can apply for enrollment of their child in NexGen School for Early Life Foundations by completing the Enrollment Application and paying the \$100 registration for the fall and \$75 registration fee for the summer. The Registration Fee is NON-REFUNDABLE.

Initial enrollment is contingent upon receipt of the completed enrollment application, signed Parent contract, registration fee, immunization records, signed health form, and signed Parent Handbook receipt.

The Enrollment Application and Fee Agreements are not meant to serve as contracts guarantee service for any duration.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations reserves the right to dismiss any parent or child at anytime with or without cause.

Continued enrollment at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations is contingent upon the parent's, emergency contact person's and child's adherence to the policies and procedures of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations as outlined in this handbook including, but not limited to, timely payment of all fees and tuition.

Parents are required to notify NexGen School for Early Life Foundations immediately, should any of the information collected at the time of enrollment or anytime thereafter change. It is very important that the children's files are kept up-to-date in case of an emergency. A suggestion and update box is located in the front lobby for anyone who needs to update any information such as phone numbers, address, etc. Please fill out a form and drop it in the box when there is no one at the front desk.

Parents will be notified immediately of any policy changes by written communication.

POLICY: TUITION

POLICY.: 6

All custodial parents and/or legal guardians are required to sign a Parent Contract prior to enrollment of their child in NexGen School for Early Life Foundations.

6.1 Payments are due the Monday of the week of service by 5:30 P.M.
Fee schedule is included in the book of this handbook.

Cash, check, money order, or credit card may pay tuition. NexGen School for Early Life Foundations accepts Visa and Master Card. Receipts will be given for tuition on payments made by cash or credit card, upon request all cash payments must be handed directly to our office manager and/or director only, or by placing in a sealed envelope with your information in our drop box.

There will be a \$25 fee charged for tuition checks returned by the bank. Returned Tuition checks will not be re-deposited. Parents will be responsible for re-issuing a second check. If at any future time the bank returns a parent's check, all future tuition payments must be made by cash, certified check, money order or credit card.

Tuition does not include fees for field trips and extra-curricular activities such as Ballet or Dance.

6.2 Payments are due by 5:30 P.M. Monday for the week of service. Payments are considered late on Tuesday of the week of service. A late fee of \$25.00 may be added to your account if payment is not made on time.

There is no credit given for vacations, scheduled school T, child illness, or for closing due to emergency situations, inclement weather or acts of God.

Non-payment of tuition is grounds for immediate dismissal from the program. Timely payments are essential for continued enrollment at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations, however, if you anticipate difficulty with paying on time, please discuss the matter with the Center Director immediately. If alternative arrangements for payment are approved you will be notified by the Center Director.

6.3 NexGen School for Early Life Foundations does accept child care subsidies. Fees are due on Monday by 5:00 for the week of service. All late payments will be reported.

Parents of a subsidized, CCMS, child must complete all required paperwork on time to continue enrollment at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations. Parents of subsidized children are also required to sign a fee agreement, agreeing to be personally responsible for the payment of tuition, in the event they become ineligible to receive child care subsidies.

6.4 Book and tuition fees and Supply fees will need to be paid by parent's participation in any child care subsidies program.

6.5 NexGen School for Early Life Foundations offers a multiple child discount for one or more siblings enrolled during the same school year. The youngest sibling pays the full tuition rate and each additional child's tuition is discounted 10% per child. Discounts are only applicable when tuition payments are made on time. The full tuition rate, plus any additional late fees will be charged when tuition payments are late as per the late tuition policy stated above.

POLICY: CONFIDENTIALITY

POLICY NO.: 7

Within NexGen School for Early Life Foundations, confidential and sensitive information will only be shared with employees of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations who have a "need to know" in order to most appropriately and safely care for your child. Confidential and sensitive information about faculty, other parents and/or children will not be shared with parents, as NexGen School for Early Life Foundations strives to protect everyone's right of privacy. Confidential information includes, but is not limited to: names, addresses, phone numbers, disability information, and HIV/AIDS status or other health related information of anyone associated with NexGen School for Early Life Foundations.

Outside of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations, confidential and sensitive information about a child will only be shared when the parent of the child has given express written consent, except where otherwise provided for by law. Parents will be provided with a document detailing the information that is to be shared outside of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations, persons with whom the information will be shared, and the reason(s) for sharing the information.

Any parent who violates the Confidentiality policy will not be permitted on agency property thereafter. Refer to the policy regarding Parents Right to Immediate Access for additional information regarding disenrollment of a child when a parent is prohibited from accessing agency property.

You may observe children at our center who are disabled or who exhibit behavior that may appear inappropriate (i.e. biting, hitting, and spitting). You may be curious or concerned about the other child. Our Confidentiality Policy protects every child's privacy. Employees of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations are strictly prohibited from discussing anything about another child with you.

7.2 Social Media

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations participates in Social Media. Children, school activities, and school work may be posted on Social Media. Should a parent wish that their child not have his/her photo posted on social media, a written request should be made writing to the Director. The request will be kept in the child file.

POLICY: MANDATED REPORTING OF SUSPECTED CHILD ABUSE AND/OR NEGLECT

POLICY NO.: 8

Under the Child Protective Services Act, mandated reporters are required to report any **suspicion** of abuse or neglect to the appropriate authorities. The employees for NexGen School for Early Life Foundations are considered mandated reporters, under this law. The employees of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations are not required to discuss their suspicions with parents prior to reporting the matter to the appropriate authorities, nor are they required to investigate the cause of any suspicious marks, behavior or condition prior to making a report. Under the Act, mandated reporters can be held criminally responsible if they fail to report suspected abuse or neglect. We at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations take this responsibility very seriously and will make all warranted reports to the appropriate authorities. The Child Protective Services Act is designed to protect the welfare and best interest of all children.

As mandated reporters, the staff of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations cannot be held liable for reports made to Child Protective Services which are determined to be unfounded, provided the report was made in "good faith."

Causes for reporting suspected child abuse or neglect include, but are not limited to:

Unusual bruising, marks, or cuts on the child's body

Severe verbal reprimands

Improper clothing relating to size, cleanliness, season

Transporting a child without appropriate child restraints (e.g. car seats, seat belts, etc.)

Dropping off or picking up a child while under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol

Not providing appropriate meals including a drink for your child

Leaving a child unattended for any amount of time

Failure to attend to the special needs of a disabled child

Sending a sick child to school over medicated to hide symptoms, which would typically require the child to be kept at home until symptoms subside.

Children who exhibit behavior consistent with an abusive situation

To report abuse or neglect, call 1-800-252-5400 or log on to www.txavusehotline.org or to www.txchildcaresearch.org. Local CPS office: 801 W. Sesame Dr. Harlingen, TX. 78550

POLICY: PREVENTING AND RESPONDING TO ABUSE

POLICY NO.: 8.1

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations staff will take the following steps to help prevent, respond to, and make aware of abuse:

All staff members are required to take annual trainings on abuse.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will make parents and employees aware of issues regarding child abuse and neglect. Including warning signs that a child may be a victim of abuse.

Increase employee and parent awareness of prevention techniques, such as wearing blue ribbons for the month of April, "Child Abuse & Neglect Awareness Month". Pamphlets will be available for Parents and staff.

Strategies for coordinating between center and appropriate community organization:

Loaves and Fishes...514 S. E. ST. Harlingen, Texas 78550- 423-1014

Family Crisis Center Inc...1602 W. Harrison Suite C-Harlingen, Texas 78550-423-9304

Mujeres Unidas/Family Justice Center-511 N. Cynthia St. -McAllen, Tx 78501-630-4878

Family Crisis Center ... 616 W. Taylor-Harlingen, TX 78550-423-9305

La Posada Providencia... 1610 Marydale Rd.- San Benito, TX 78586-399-3826

Cameron County Child Advocacy/Maggie's House...2400 W. Expressway 83- San Benito, TX 361-3331

End of The Road Ministries... 311 W. Harrison, Harlingen, TX-425-2278

If any parent of employee should suspect a child is a victim of child abuse or neglect they should contact their local Police Department, 911, or they can call any of the numbers listed above.

POLICY: PARENT CODE OF CONDUCT

POLICY NO.: 9

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations requires the parents of enrolled children at all times, to behave in a manner consistent with decency, courtesy, and respect. One of the goals of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations is to provide the most appropriate environment in which as child can grow, learn, and develop. Achieving this ideal environment is not only the responsibility of the employees of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations but, is the responsibility of each and every parent or adult who enters the center. Parents are required to behave in a manner that fosters this ideal environment. **Parents who violate the Parent Code of Conduct will not be permitted on agency property thereafter.** Please refer to the Policy on Parent's Right to Immediate Access for additional information regarding dis-enrollment of the child when a parent is prohibited from accessing agency property.

9.1 SWEARING/CURSING:

No parent or adult is permitted to curse or use other inappropriate language on agency property at any time, whether in the presence of a child or not. Such language is considered offensive by many people and will not be tolerated. If a parent or adult feels frustrated or angry, it is more appropriate to verbally express the frustration or anger using non-offensive language. At NO time shall inappropriate language be directed toward members of the staff.

9.2 THREATNING OF EMPLOYEES, CHILDREN OTHER PARENTS OF ADULTS ASSOCIATED WITH NexGen School for Early Life Foundations:

At no time is any person permitted to carry any type of Firearm, Ammunitions, and/or Weapon on agency property for any reason. Violation of this policy will result in immediate dismissal from the program.

Threats of any kind will not be tolerated. In today's society, NexGen School for Early Life Foundations cannot afford to sit by idly while threats are made. In addition, all threats will be reported to the appropriate authorities and will be prosecuted to the fullest extent of the law. While apologies for such behavior are appreciated, the agency will not assume the risk of a second chance. **PARENTS MUST BE RESPONSIBLE FOR AND IN CONTROL OF THEIR BEHAVIOR AT ALL TIMES.**

9.3 PHYSICAL/VERBAL PUNISHMENT OF YOUR CHILD OR OTHER CHILDREN AT NexGen School for Early Life Foundations:

While NexGen School for Early Life Foundation does not necessarily support nor condone corporal punishment of children, such acts are not permitted in the child care facility. While verbal reprimands may be appropriate is not appropriate for parents to verbally abuse their child. Doing so may cause undue embarrassment or emotional distress. Parents are always welcome to discuss a behavior issue with the teacher and to seek advice and guidance regarding appropriate and effective disciplinary procedures.

Parents are prohibited from addressing, for the purpose of correction or discipline, a child that is not their own. Of course, no parent or other adult may physically punish another parent's child. If a parent should witness another parent's child behaving in an inappropriate manner, or is concerned about behavior reported to them by their own child, it is most appropriate for the parent to direct their concern to the classroom teacher and/or Center Director.

Furthermore, it is wholly inappropriate for one parent to seek out another parent to discuss their child's inappropriate behavior. All behavior concerns should be brought to the classroom teacher or director's attention. At that point, the teacher and/or director will address the issue with the other parent. Although you may be curious as to the outcome of such as discussion, teachers and/or the Center Director are strictly prohibited from discussing anything about another child with you. All children enrolled in our agency have privacy rights and are further protected by our Confidentiality Policy. You may be assured that we will not discuss anything about your child with another parent or adult visiting the center.

9.4 SMOKING:

For the health of all NexGen School for Early Life Foundation employees, children and associates, smoking is prohibited anywhere on agency property. Parents are prohibited from smoking in the building, on the grounds, and in the parking lot of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations. Parents who are smoking in their cars must dispose of the cigarette prior to entering the parking lot.

9.5 VIOLATIONS OF THE SAFETY POLICY:

Parents are required to follow all safety procedures at all times. These procedures are designed not as mere inconveniences, but to protect the welfare and best interest of the employees, children and associates of NexGen School for Early Life Foundation. Please be particularly mindful of NexGen School for Early Life Foundation entrance procedures. We all like to be polite. However, we need to be careful not to allow unauthorized individuals into the center. Holding the door open for the person following you may, in fact, be polite; however that person may not be authorized to enter the premises. Security procedures are only as strong as the weakest person in our organizational chain. Be alert and mindful. Immediately report any breaches to the Center Director.

9.6 CONFRONTATIONAL INTERACTIONS WITH EMPLOYEES, OTHER PARENTS OR ASSOCIATES OF NexGen School for Early Life Foundation: While it is understood that parents will not always agree with the employees of NexGen School for Early Life Foundation or other parents of the other children, it is expected that all disagreements be handled in a calm and respectful manner. Confrontational interactions are not an appropriate means by which to communicate a point and are strictly prohibited.

9.7 VIOLATIONS OF THE CONFIDENTIALITY POLICY:

NexGen school for Early Life Foundation takes the responsibility of maintaining the confidentiality of all persons associated with the agency very seriously. Parents must understand the implications of this responsibility. Parents need to recognize that the Confidentiality Policy not only applies to their child or family, but all children, families and employees associated with NexGen School for Ealy Life Foundation. Any parent who shares any information considered to be confidential, pressures employees or other parents for information which is not necessary for them to know, will be considered to be in violation of the Confidentiality Policy.

POLICY: PARENT'S RIGHT TO IMMEDIATE ACCESS

POLICY NO.: 10

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NexGen School for Early Life Foundation has an open door policy. Parents of a child in our care are entitled to immediate access, without prior notice, to their child whenever they are in care at NexGen School for Early Life Foundation. Door code will be issued to parents upon enrollment and should not be given out to anyone other than parents.

In cases where the child is the subject of a court order (e.g., Custody Order, Restraining Order, or Protection from Abuse Order) NexGen School for Early Life Foundation must be provided with a **Certified Copy** of the most recent requests a more liberal variation of the order in writing. In the case where both parents are afforded shared/joint custody by order of the court, both parents must sign the request for more liberal interpretation of the order.

In the absence of a court order on file with NexGen School for Early Life Foundation, both parents shall be afforded equal access to their child as stipulated by law. NexGen School for Early Life Foundation cannot, without a court order, limit the access of a one parent by request of the other parent, regardless of the reason. If a situation presents itself where one parent does not want the other parent to have access to their child, NexGen School for Early Life Foundation suggests that the parent keep the child with them until a court order is issued, since our rights to retain your child are secondary to the other parent's right to immediate access. NexGen School for Early Life Foundation staff will contact the local police should a conflict arise.

Visitors are asked to schedule appointments with the Center Director, and are allowed in the childcare facility only at the discretion of the Center Director. An employee of NexGen School for Early Life Foundation will accompany visitors at all times, throughout the center.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundation will dismiss any child whose parent is prohibited from entering upon agency property. Due to the parents' right to immediate access policy, as well as state and federal regulations, NexGen School for Early Life Foundation cannot have a child at the agency when the child's enrollment even if the parent agrees to stay out of the center. Such an agreement is a violation of the law and will not be entertained.

POLICY: DISMISSAL

POLICY NO.: 11

NexGen School for Early Life Foundation reserves the right to dismiss any child at any time, with or without cause.

Parents will be refunded any unused tuition within two weeks of the dismissal. An agency check will be mailed to the address indicated in the child's file. Any past due balances must be paid within 30 days of the dismissal. An invoice detailing the past due balance will be forwarded to the address indicated in the child's file within one week of the dismissal. Any balances remaining after the 30 day period will be referred to the agency's legal counsel for collection.

The Center Director or designee will assist the parent in gathering their child's belongings at the time of dismissal and parents are required to leave agency property in a calm and respectful manner, immediately. NexGen School for Early Life Foundation will request assistance from local police should any parent become disruptive and/or uncooperative while gathering their child's belongings upon dismissal.

A dismissed child and his/her parents are required to call and request an appointment with the Center Director if they wish to return to agency property following a dismissal. Appointments are made at the discretion of the Center Director and are not a right of the dismissed child or parent.

Following a dismissal, any parent or child who harasses, threatens or in any manner causes harm to anyone affiliated with the agency by calling, writing, or any other means, will be prosecuted to the fullest extent of the law, by NexGen School for Early Life Foundation.

POLICY: WITHDRAW

POLICY NO.: 12

Two weeks written notice is required when withdrawing a child for any reason. If the proper notice is given, any unused tuition and deposit will be refunded within thirty days of the withdrawal. If the required notice is not given, parents will be charged tuition for two additional weeks and will not have their deposit refunded.

The parents and child, following their last day of enrollment, are not permitted to re-enter agency property without prior permission of the Center Director. A withdrawn child and his/her parents are required to call and request an appointment with the Center Director if they wish to return to agency property following the last day of enrollment at NexGen School for Early Life Foundation. Appointments are made at the discretion of the Center Director and are not a right of the withdrawn child or parent.

Parents who wish to change their child's days or times of enrollment at NexGen School for Early Life Foundation, must submit a request to do so two weeks in advance of the proposed change. Schedule changes are subject to a change fee of NexGen School for Early Life Foundation.

The Center Director will notify the parents in writing if the new schedule is available. A schedule change will not be considered to be final until a new fee agreement is signed. If the schedule change requires an additional deposit and/or registration fee, the change will also be contingent upon payment of these monies. If the requested schedule is not available parents may choose to continue parents may choose to continue with the current schedule until such time as the requested schedule becomes available, or may choose to withdraw their child from the program. The date the request for the Center Director receives the schedule change will be used to toll the two week notice required for withdraw.

POLICY: COURT ORDERS EFFECTING ENROLLED CHILDREN

POLICY NO.: 13

In cases where an enrolled child is the subject of a court order (exp. Custody Order, Restraining Order, or Protection from Abuse Order) NexGen School for Early Life Foundation must be provided with a **Certified Copy** of the most recent order and all amendments thereof. The orders of the court will be strictly followed unless the custodial parent(s) requests a more liberal variation of the order in writing. In the case where both parents are afforded shared/joint custody by order of the court, both parents must sign the request for more liberal interpretation of the order.

In absence of a court order on file with NexGen School for Early Life Foundation administration, both parents shall be afforded equal access to their child as stipulated by law.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundation cannot, without a court order, limit the access of a one parent by request of the other parent, regardless of the reason. If a situation presents itself, where one parent does not want the other parent to have access to their child, NexGen School for Early Life Foundation suggests that the parent keep the child with them until a court order is issued.

If conflicting court orders are presented, the most recently dates court order will be followed.

Once presented with a Protection from Abuse Order or a Restraining Order, NexGen School for Early Life Foundation is obligated to follow the order for the entire period it is in effect. Employees of NexGen School for Early Life Foundation cannot, at the request of anyone, except the issuing judge, allow a Protection from Abuse Order and/or a Restraining Order to be violated. NexGen School for Early Life Foundation will report any violations of these orders to the court.

POLICY: ARRIVAL PROCEDURES

POLICY NO.: 14

Upon arrival at NexGen School for Early Life Foundation, the parents or the adult dropping the child off

must sign the child into care on the sign-in sheet located in the front lobby. Children are required to be escorted by their parent or the adult dropping them off to their designated classroom. Children are required by law to be supervised at all times while in the child care facility. Parents are required to help children put away their outerwear in their appropriate classroom and get settled for the day.

Parents are informed of the significance of consistent arrival time. Children should arrive before the educational

Portion of the program begins to limit disruption. Consistent routines prepare children for the transition to Kindergarten.

We recommend parents limit technology use on-site (e.g. refrain from cell phone use.) In order to facilitate better communication between the parents and caregivers and the parents and child, it is best if parent are not

Distracted by use of electronic devices while at the center/home.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundation discourages parent from sneaking out of the center. Some children exhibit separation anxiety when it is time for their parent to leave. NexGen School for Early Life Foundation believes it is best for parents to tell the anxious child upon arrival that after all of the child's things are put away, the parent will kiss, hug and say goodbye to the child. The parent will prepare the child for their departure. The employee present in goodbye. The longer the parent of an anxious child drags out the departure, the more anxiety the child is likely to feel. The professional employees of NexGen School for Early Life Foundation are available to discuss other options if the child does not settle into the arrival routine after a reasonable period of time.

At arrival, parents are required to follow the Medication Policy if a child must receive medication during the course of the day.

Parents are required to notify the child's teacher or Center Director of any special instructions or needs for the child's day. The parent must present the special instructions in the form of a letter and verbally discuss them with either the classroom teacher or Center Director. These special instructions include but are not limited to: Early Pick Up, Alternative Pick up Person, health issues over the previous night which need to be observed and/or any general issues of concern which the child care providers should be aware to best meet the needs of your child throughout the day. Upon arrival, the receiving teacher(s) will make a quick health check assessment of the children and document any visible marks or bruising. A report will be given to the child's parent when they arrive for pick up at the end of the day.

14.1 NOTIFICATION OF ABSENCE

Parents are asked to inform the center by 9 A.M. if a child will not be at the center on a scheduled day. This will enable the center to more effectively maintain appropriate ratios and help the classroom teacher effectively plan for the day.

If your child is ill, we request that you notify the center director not only of the absence, but also of the nature of the illness. This enables our faculty to keep track of any illnesses, which may occur at our school. This information will only be shared with staff on a "need to know" basis. If your child has communicable disease, we ask that you share the diagnosis with the Center Director, so that the parents of the children in the school may be notified that a communicable disease is present. Once again, only the communicable disease information will be shared. NexGen School for Early Life Foundation will take all measure necessary to protect your child's confidentiality. Parents are not required to disclose this information by law, and your continued enrollment will not be based whatsoever on your decision to share, (or not) the reason for your child's absence from school.

Parents who know in advance that a child will be late, are required to notify the center by 9:00 A.M. so as to maintain the appropriate number of employees to ensure ratios are met when the child arrives to school.

If a child is expected to miss over 3 days of class, please advise your classroom teacher for make-up work and assignments.

14.2 AGENCY'S RIGHT TO REFUSE ADMISSION

NexGen School for Early Life Foundation reserves the right to refuse admission to any child at any time with or without cause.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations strives to maintain an ample list of substitutes in anticipation of staff absences, however, there are times when substitutes are not available, and classrooms need to be closed to maintain compliance with licensing regulations. Refusal will be based on a "first come first served" basis when seeking to maintain appropriate staff to child ratios and/or when closing classrooms.

1. Possible reasons for the refusal of admission include but are not limited to:
 2. Lack of staff to maintain appropriate Staff to Child Ratios as determined by State Licensing Regulations.
 3. The need to maintain compliance with Licensing Regulations.
 4. Staff deems the child to ill to attend.
 5. Domestic Situations that present a safety risk to the child, staff or other children enrolled at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations if the child were to be present at the center.
 6. Parent's failure to maintain accurate, up to date records.
 7. Parent's failure to complete and return required documentation in a timely fashion.
- Parent will not be reimbursed tuition for days when their child is refused admission to the program.

POLICY: PICK UP PROCEDURES

POLICY NO: 15

Parents or other authorized adults are required to sign their child out of care on the sign-out sheet located at the front lobby. Once a parent signs their child out, the parent is then solely responsible for supervising their child while on agency premises. The parent may not allow a child to wander through the hallways, bathrooms, other classrooms and/or playground. Parents are requested to handle all business issues prior to signing out their child. Parents should refrain from using cell phones or other electronic devices when picking up their child or in the parking lot. This will avoid any distractions talking with your child's teacher and/or driving.

Parents or persons designated to act "in loco parentis" are required to sign any incident/accident reports from the day at pick-up. The classroom teacher will be able to briefly discuss the matter with you or other authorized adult at pick-up. However, should you feel it necessary to have an in depth discussion or meeting. It is most appropriate to schedule the meeting for a later date because the teacher is responsible for supervising the remaining children in the classroom. A telephone conference may be scheduled for later in the day or for the next day at nap/rest time if the parent(s) is unable to meet at the center during the course of the day.

15.1 LATE PICK-UP

Late fee will begin at 12:00 noon for Half-Day students, 5:35 P.M. for Full-Day and after school students. All measurements of time are to be according to NexGen School for Early Life Foundations clock located in the front lobby.

Late fees will be assessed at \$5.00 for each 5 minute increments. Late fees are due by 5:30 P.M. the day after late pick-up.

15.2 PERSONS APPEARING TO BE IMPAIRED BY DRUGS/ALCOHOL AT PICK-UP

The staff of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will contact local police and/or the other custodial parent should a parent appear to the staff of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations to be under the influence of drugs and/or alcohol. The parent's right to immediate access does not permit the agency from denying a custodial parent access to their child even if the parent is or appears to be impaired. However, NexGen School for Early Life Foundations staff will delay the impaired parent as long as possible, while contacting the other parent, the local police and Child Protective Services.

Any other authorized person who attempts to pick-up a child, and appears to the staff of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations to be under the influence of drugs and/ or alcohol will be denied access to the child. The staff of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will contact the child's parents, local police and Child Protective Services to notify them of the situation.

15.3 EMERGENCY/ALTERNATE PICK-UP FORMS

At enrollment, parents will be presented with an Emergency/Alternate Pick-Up form. Parents are encouraged to include on this form any, and all persons who, in the course of events, may at one time be asked to pick-up their child from NexGen School for Early Foundations. In an emergency situation the child's parents will be called first. If they cannot be reached staff will call the persons listed on this form until someone can be reached.

Should the staff contact a parent, and the parent is unable to pick up the child, it is then the responsibility of the parent to arrange for their child to be picked up by someone on the emergency list.

Parents do not need to be listed on the Emergency contact Form. The nature of the parental relationship affords the parents (in the absence of a court order indicating otherwise) the right to pick-up their child.

Parents will be asked to determine which persons (if any) on the Emergency/Alternate Pick-up form has the right to act "In Loco Parentis." In Loco Parentis status affords the pickup person the right to discuss confidential information about the child's day including but not limited to, incident/accident reports, and behavior issues. In the absence of this designation the people on the Emergency/Alternate Pick Up Form are only afforded the right to pick up the child. Staff is not permitted to discuss the child's day with them.

The persons on the Emergency/Alternate pick-up form will be required to provide Government issued photo ID prior to the agency releasing the child.

All changes and/or additions to the Emergency/Alternate Pick-up form must be made in writing and be dated and signed. Only custodial parents have the right to make changes or additions to this form.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations reserves the right to refuse/ban any person listed on the Emergency/Alternate Contact Form for any reason, including but not limited to violations of the policies/procedures contained herein. It is the responsibility of the enrolling parent(s) to inform each person on the Emergency/Alternate Form of the policies/procedures contained herein.

POLICY: TRANSPORTATION

POLICY NO.: 16

NexGen School for Early Life Foundation will have transportation available for afternoon pick-up for grades Pre-Kinder through Fifth grade.

Children will be transported in a mini-school bus to provide the best safety standards available. Parents are welcomed to view the bus when staff is available.

See attached list of pick-up times and schools for which transportation is provided.

POLICY: SCHOOL CALENDAR

POLICY NO.: 17

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will normally follow HCISD calendar for Fall & Summer Sessions.

Only 9 days are allotted for CLOSURE as per Cameron Works Provider. Dates will vary, but will fall on or around the following holiday:

19.3 STAFF TO CHILD RATIOS

Staff will be assigned to group of children as outlined in the Texas Minimum Standards.

19.4 NAP/REST TIME

Nap/Rest time will take place after lunch and clean-up. Nap/rest time is on each grade level's daily schedule. Children are not forced to take a nap, but are encouraged to do so. Children who do not want to nap will be allowed to participate in a quiet activity so as to allow others to nap.

19.5 EDUCATIONAL/PERSONAL CARE SUPPLIES NEEDED

Every child who is enrolled will need to pay \$80 (Registration fee) for every fall session and \$25 (Registration fee) for the summer session. Both these fees are used to pay for any classroom materials needed by the teachers such as workbooks, paints, drawing paper, brushes, craft supplies, etc...

Personal care supplies needed for each child are: a change of clothing, a sleeping mat, a light blanket, travel-size pillow (if child prefers), and a backpack. Additional supplies needed at the beginning of the school year and replenished as per teacher request are: crayons, folders, pencil pouch, writing tables, box of Kleenex, hand sanitizer pump, Clorox wipes, etc... A supply list will be given to the parents every fall and summer session.

19.6 BIRTHDAY/HOLIDY CELEBRATIONS

Birthdays are a special time for children and we welcome the celebration of the special day with classmates. Please let your child's teacher know of your plans in advance.

No hard candy or gum can be allowed in candy bags. We encourage peanut butter crackers, goldfish crackers, fruit (cut in bite size for grapes and apples etc...), small books, flashcards, etc...to be used in place of candy in goody bags, if given. Summer birthdays may be celebrated in May if child will not be attending summer session.

Holiday celebrations will be held throughout the year (i.e., Christmas, Valentine's Day etc...).

Parents will be notified in advance. Please inform your classroom teacher if your child is not allowed to participate in any of the planned holiday celebrations.

Only store bought cupcakes are allowed for celebrations.

19.7 PARENT/TEACHER CONFERENCES/COMMUNICATION

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will provide ongoing communication with all parents throughout the school year. Newsletters, notices, and verbal contact (in person/phone) will be used to keep parents aware of activities and school issues.

Teacher conferences are offered twice a year to discuss child progress, experience, or to prepare for school readiness. Conferences are held in the middle of the fall term (October) and at the end of the spring term (May), scheduled through teacher/parent mutual agreement time slots.

CLI engage checklists are used in evaluation for infants and toddlers. CIRCLE is another evaluation used for Pre-K students.

Questions, concerns, and ideas are always welcomed.

Parents who wish to contact the Licensing office in Harlingen may do so at 412.4710. To report abuse or neglect, parents may call 1.800.252.5400 or log on to www.tdprs.state.tx.us

19.8 GRADUATION

Graduation ceremonies will be held in May for the Kindergarten Graduates. Parents are welcomed and encouraged to help with the planning and preparation of this special day.

19.9 SCHOOL PRAYER

Children pray before each meal at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations.

Prayer. "God is good; God is great, let us thank Him for our food. Birds that sing, grass that's green, let us thank Him for everything. Amen."

Parents who do not wish their child to participate in prayer needs to provide us with a written note.

POLICY: DISCIPLINE & PROCEDURES FOR ADDRESSING CHALLENGING BEHAVIORS

POLICY NO.: 20

It is our goal to provide a safe, healthy atmosphere in which all children will have the opportunity to grow and learn.

NexGen partners with families to develop consistent strategies between home and school to support children demonstrating challenging behaviors of poor behavior will be made and kept in student's file. We expect full cooperation from all parents in assisting teachers and Director to modify unacceptable behavior. Teachers and/or staff are not allowed to spank or slap children to correct behavior. The following steps will be taken to correct behavioral problems.

Teacher-Student Procedures:

1. Connect: Teachers respond calmly and help children identify their feelings. We acknowledge emotions and support children in understanding what they are experiencing.
2. Redirect: Children are guided toward appropriate behavior through modeling, choices, and clear expectations. If needed, a child may use a supervised classroom calm-down space to regain control in a supportive manner.
3. Restore: Once calm, teachers help children problem-solve, repair relationships, and practice appropriate behaviors. Logical consequences may be used when appropriate.

Teacher-Parent Procedures:

Teacher will make parent aware of child's behavior and have them sign a written Behavior Report on the day of incident. Educational/ Behavioral reading material and Strategies will be discussed to support child. All Behavior Report will be saved in the child's folder.

Director-Parent Procedures:

If student continues to demonstrate serious behavior such as hurting or attempting to hurt another child, uncontrollable behavior, and/or becomes a danger to his/her classmates, they will be removed from the class and taken to Director's office. A parent conference will be called immediately and child will need to be taken home after the conference.

If discipline problem cannot be corrected the Director reserves the right to withdraw the child from the program.

POLICY: TOY'S FROM HOME

POLICY NO.: 21

Due to the risk of damage, sharing issues, and loss, children are not permitted to bring in toys from home, unless specifically requested by the classroom teacher for use as part of the curriculum. Parents are asked to help us enforce this policy with their child. Parents are encouraged to consult the classroom teacher should they find their child is having difficulty with this policy.

Children in classrooms with nap/rest time are permitted to include with their bedding supplies, one plush/non-musical toy with which to nap/rest. This toy is to be placed with the bedding supplies and use of it will only be allowed at nap/rest time.

22.1 CHILDREN

Clothing:

School shirt with or without collars are required Monday through Thursday. Friday's are "free days," and children can wear clothing of their choice. Shirts are available at the Front Lobby.

Children are engaged in various activities during the course of the day; some of these activities can be messy, and/or athletic in nature. Additionally, children are engaged in outdoor play daily, weather permitting. Due to these activities, children are required to be dressed in seasonably appropriate, comfortable clothing. Shorts are recommended for the greater part of the year so children can remain cool. Pants are recommended in times of cold weather.

Parents are prohibited from dressing children in overalls, or clothing with difficult closures. These types of clothing present particular challenges for children in relation to toileting.

Children are not permitted to wear open toed, and/or open backed shoes. The most appropriate type of shoes for participation in school activities are rubber-soled, sneakers/tennis shoes.

All children are required to have one seasonably and size appropriate complete change of clothing at the center at all times. Children under 3 years of age are required to have two seasonably and size appropriate, complete changes of clothing at the center at all times. A complete change of clothing includes: shirt, shorts, underwear, socks, and shoes. Teachers will post reminders for parents to update changes of clothing as the weather begins to change.

All clothing items must be clearly labeled with the child's first and last name. NexGen School for early Life Foundations is not responsible for lost or damaged items of clothing.

Jewelry/Accessories:

Children are not permitted to wear necklaces or dangling earrings of any kind. It is a safety hazard for your child as well as the other children enrolled in the program. In addition, NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will not be responsible for lost or stolen valuables. It is the parents' resistibility to enforce this policy with their children. Should a child come to school wearing any jewelry, parents will be required to take it with them, or to return to the school to remove the jewelry if it discovered after the parent leaves.

Hair beads, barrettes, bobby pins, etc. are not to be worn by children. These accessories are considered to be safety hazards. When choosing accessories for your children, be mindful of the potential safety issues they present not only for your child, but also for the older and younger children.

22.2 PARENTS

Clothing:

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations

Parents are asked to dress appropriately while at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations, or involved in any school-sponsored events. Inappropriate clothing would include, revealing, extremely short, ripped/torn (in inappropriate places), and/or see through articles of clothing. Anything with suggestive or vulgar language is prohibited.

Parents wearing high heels, work boots, or shoes with wet/dirty soles, will be required to remove their shoes prior to entering any classroom with children under 2 ½ years of age. This will reduce the risk of injury to a child on the floor, and will help to maintain a clean floor. Parents can simply leave their shoes outside the classroom door prior to entering the classroom.

Jewelry:

While volunteering in the classroom or at any NexGen School for Early Life Foundations sponsored event, parents are advised not to wear any jewelry and/or accessories as per the children's staff's dress code policy outlined above for the safety of the parent and children.

POLICY: FIELD TRIPS

POLICY NO.: 23

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations occasionally supplements the in-class curriculum with off premise field trips. Parents are required to give written permission for their child to attend each field trip. Notification of a field trip will be sent home in advance of the trip, with all pertinent trip information including, destination, date, time, reason for trip, cost, and mode of transportation. Accompanying the notification paper, teachers will include a permission slip to be filled out, signed, and returned to the teacher prior to the date of the trip. The field trip permission slip must be filled out completely and accurately, and all trip costs must be paid in advance in order for your child to attend.

If parents wish to attend the trip with their child, they should discuss attending with the classroom teacher. NexGen School for Early Life Foundations provides all required supervision for all field trips, but always invites and welcomes parents to attend.

Parents will not be permitted to transport any child, other than their own, on a school sponsored trip.

If your child is not scheduled to attend on the day of a field trip and you wish for your child to participate in the trip, please discuss this with your child's teacher at least three days prior to the date of the trip. Your child will be permitted to attend if required ratio's can be maintained with his/her addition to the class. Any fees needed for the trip and signed permission slip will be due prior to the date of the trip.

POLICY: PARENT PARTICIPATION/VOLUNTEERS

POLICY NO.: 24

Parents are invited and encouraged to be involved in their child's school activities. There are many different ways in which parents can participate and volunteer at the childcare center. Parents may volunteer to attend trips, read in the classroom, assist teachers, and/or coordinate special events. Teachers will have posted in their classrooms any volunteer opportunities available. Parents not interested in volunteering directly in the classroom may donate items, do maintenance work, or assist in the front office. These volunteer opportunities are posted in the main office area on the parent bulletin board.

Any parent who volunteers in the classroom on a regular basis will be required to pay for and secure all criminal background checks, as required by our licensing regulations. Any person, including parents, with felony convictions, sex offender convictions and/or open investigations into any criminal activities will not be permitted to volunteer in the classroom, or on field trips.

Parents with court orders detailing custodial arrangements will only be permitted to volunteer on days in which they are afforded custody (joint/shared custody arrangement) as per the court order. For example, if a parent is afforded custody on Tuesdays and Wednesdays that parent will only be able to volunteer on those days. Parents with visitation only (sole/exclusive custody arrangements), will only be permitted to volunteer with the express written permission of the custodial parent.

24.1 FUNDRAISERS

Fundraisers will be limited to two per school year. One will be held in the Fall and one in the Spring. Money raised will help for school activities, family programs and functions, children projects, new playground equipment etc. Notification of the use of fundraising money will be given to the parents as well as information for each of the fundraisers.

All parents are required to participate in each of the fundraisers for the school year. If tickets are not sold,

or you choose not to participate please note a \$25.00 charge will be added to your account.

24.2 DONATIONS

Donations of items such as coffee cans, yam, paints, magazines, art supplies, etc...are always welcomed. Check your monthly newsletter for information on items you may have lying around at home that could be put to good instructional use in the classroom.

24.3 Updating Account Information

If needed, parents are allowed to update information in our system. Parents must be the ones to initiate information updating by reaching out to the facility via phone, email or suggestion box located at the front desk.

24.4 Annual Surveys

Each year our facility will be handing out surveys to acquire feedback on our services. We use the surveys to update our curriculum and evaluate our care for personal and professional development.

Your support is greatly appreciated.

POLICY: HEALTH AND SAFETY

POLICY NO.: 25

25.1 PRE-ENROLLMENT REQUIREMENTS

Each child is required to complete a pre-enrollment packet of information. This packet is to be returned to the center's office prior to the child's first day of attendance. All children are required to have a complete up to date immunization record on file. This is per our licensing regulations. If you have chosen not to have your child immunized, please ask the center director for an immunization waiver form. Immunizations may be waived for certain reasons. Please discuss this with the center director to determine whether you have the right to be enrolled and not have your child immunized. Parents are required to have a waiver on file in place of an immunization record, so that the center can maintain compliance with licensing regulations.

All children are also required to have a Health form on file. The health form indicates the child's fitness to attend school, must be completed by a licensed healthcare professional and returned to the Center Director within the first 7 days of enrollment.

25.2 Staff Immunizations:

1. All staff at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will have a TB shot administered upon hiring. Staff members will be asked to take a TB shot if someone has been exposed to TB or any other Influenza or has shown any symptoms of being sick.
2. Recommended vaccines will be administered to staff when required by Health Dept.
3. A copy of staff current vaccinations will be kept in their personnel files for further reference. Any employee refusing to comply with administering any immunizations must have a letter in writing explaining why he/she will not be in compliance by a physician. After further review from the director, the staff member who is not in compliance will be advised of what action will be taken to protect the children from the center.
4. If an employee does not receive the required immunizations, does not have a written excuse, and does not follow protocol it will be up to the director of the facility to decide what actions will be taken as a result of non-compliance.

25.3 COMMUNICABLE DISEASES

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations follows all health/communicable disease policies as outlined in the American Academy of Pediatrics Model Health Policies and Procedures Manual. A copy of this manual is on file with the Center Director and is available upon request for review. Additionally, copies can be

purchased, for a nominal fee, from the National Association for the Educational of the Young Child (NAEYC).

Parents are required to pick up an ill child within 45 minutes of notification by phone. If a parent is reached, but cannot pick their child within 45 minutes, it becomes the parent's responsibility to arrange for alternate pick up with someone listed on the child's emergency contact form. The staff will not continue to call those listed on the emergency contact list once a parent is reached. If a parent cannot be reached, the staff will begin to call the people listed on the emergency contact form, until arrangements can be made for the child to be picked up.

Children excluded from the program due to a fever may not return to the program until they are fever free without fever reducing medication, for 24 hours. If your child is sent home due to a fever, he/she is not permitted to return to the program the following day at a minimum. A fever is defined as a temperature reading on a thermometer of at least 101 degrees Fahrenheit or more as taken under the arm.

Children are required to be excluded from the program for loose bowels or diarrhea which occur 3 or more times in a 24 hours period of time. Children may return to the program when normal bowel movements resume.

If your child will be absent due to illness, we request that you notify the center director. This enables our faculty to keep track of any illnesses, which may occur at our school. This information will only be shared with faculty on a "need to know" basis. If your child has a communicable disease, we ask that you share the diagnosis with the center director, so that the parents of the children in the school may be notified that a communicable disease is present. Once again, only the communicable disease information will be shared. NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will take all measure necessary to protect your child's confidentiality. You are not required to disclose this information by law, and your continued enrollment will not be based whatsoever on your decision to share, (or not) the reason for your child's absence from school.

25.4 BITING

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations recognizes that biting is a developmentally appropriate behavior for children in the infant through 2 ½ year old classrooms. Parents with children in these classrooms should expect that their children may be bit, or will bite another child. The staff understands that parents are concerned and can be upset when their child is involved in a biting incident. We ask that you remember this is a developmentally appropriate behavior, and that the staff is working to identify situations which provoke, and/or elicit this behavior so it can be prevented in the future. The staff will not punish, or harshly discipline children in the younger classrooms for biting behavior; they will simply redirect the children to different activities in separate areas of the classroom. Parents are expected to work with staff to identify methods and strategies to curb this behavior. Uncooperative parents will have their child's services terminated.

Children older than 3 years of age may occasionally be involved in a biting incident. For children in this age group who bite, the staff will use the discipline procedures outlined in the discipline section of this handbook, as well as observe the child to determine what provokes or elicits this inappropriate behavior. Parents are expected to cooperate with staff to help their child control this behavior. Uncooperative parents will have their child's service terminated. Furthermore, children, in the older age groups, who bite 4 or more times in a school year will have their services terminated since, the safety of all the children in the program is of the utmost concern of NexGen School for Early Life Founda.

Parents will be notified by incident/accident report that a biting incident occurred during the course of the day. The staff may not discuss with either parent the identity of the other child involved in the incident. This information is considered to be confidential and cannot be disclosed. The staff of NexGen School of Early Life Foundations cannot discuss the medical history of any child involved in a biting incident with the other party. It is recommended that any child involved in a biting incident be seen by their family physician if the parents are concerned about the communicable diseases possibly resulting from the biting incident.

25.5 DISPENSING MEDICATION

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will only dispense over-the-counter and/or prescription medication that is in original labeled containers. Parents are required to complete a Medication Form for that medication that is to be dispensed. Medication Forms can be found in the front lobby. Medication Form medication must be turned into child's teacher if present when dropping off medication or to the staff in the front lobby. Medication forms expire after the original date it was written.

Teachers and staff may get verbal permission for one dosage of medication if the parent did not fill out Medication Form. Teachers and staff will not administer more medication than what the label calls for.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will dispense over-the-counter, fever reducing/pain medication (ex. Children's Tylenol, Children's Motrin) on an as needed basis, with a doctor's or parent's note detailing the recommended reasons for administration and appropriate dosage. Parents are required to supply an unopened bottle of the fever reducing/pain medication clearly labeled with their child's name. (One note and bottle of fever reducing/pain medication is required per child.) Prior to administering fever reducing/pain medication, staff will contact a parent or person listed on emergency contact form, if a parent cannot be reached, to inform them of our need to administer the medication. Staff will also inform the parent or emergency contact person if it is necessary for the child to be picked up due to illness. Refer to the policy listed above regarding picking up ill children.

Parents are responsible for ensuring that all prescription medication is properly labeled by a pharmacist and replaced prior to the expiration date.

Diaper ointment, sun screen, and insect repellent cannot be administered without a Medication Form.

25.6 FIRE/EMERGENCY DRILLS

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations conducts monthly fire and emergency/evacuation drills. Parents, staff and children will not be made aware of drill dates or times, as this is the most effective way to assess the effectiveness of fire and emergency/evacuation plans.

During a fire/emergency drill or real fire/emergency situation, parents may not sign children into or out of the program. Parents must wait until the drill is complete and children have returned to the building to sign their child into the program. Parents may feel free to wait with the child's class in the designated safe-zone outside of the building until the drill is complete.

In the event of a real fire/emergency situation, the director or designate will inform each classroom teacher that the school will be closing. At this time any parents waiting to sign their child in will have to leave the premises with their child. All other parents or emergency contact persons will be notified by telephone of the situation. As with the sick child pick up policy, children must be picked up within 45 minutes of the telephone call.

Parents wishing to sign their child out of the program during a fire/emergency drill or real fire/emergency situation are expected to have patience with the staff as they are trying to maintain order during a hectic and dangerous situation. If the center is in the midst of a fire/emergency drill, parents will be required to wait until the drill is completed and the staff and children are returned to the building to sign their child out of the program. If the center is having a real fire/emergency situation, parents will be asked to wait until the director or designee has accounted for all staff and children and gives the staff permission to release children. Once again, it is important for parents and staff to work together, remain calm, and cooperate with the fire/emergency personnel and center administration during these important and critical situations.

25.7 ALTERNATE SAFE LOCATION

Should the administration of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations or any emergency services personnel determine the building which houses the child care agency to be too dangerous to be occupied,

the staff and children will be taken to Harlingen High School South or Destiny Christian Academy. Once the children are assembled here, the staff will begin contacting parents or emergency contact persons for pick up. As stated before, children must be picked up within 45 minutes of the telephone call.

Shelter in place/Lock Downs

Severe Weather drills are practiced 4 times a year. In case of inclement weather, the children and staff will relocate **within the building** to their assigned severe weather relocation rooms. Teachers will escort their students to the designated shelter room where they shall account for children and insure that no one leaves the designated room/safe area until the all clear is given by the director or designee. Teachers and staff will keep the students calm during this time with story time activities. If needed, teachers and staff will instruct the students to get under tables for shelter. If at any point the director sees it too dangerous to remain in the building, all teachers and staff will be evacuated and relocated to an alternate location.

Intruder drills are practiced 4 times a year. An evacuation and lock down plan may take place at the center if there should be a situation that may result in the harm to persons inside the child care center, including but not limited to a shooting, intruder, hostage incident or any situation deemed harmful at the discretion of the director or public safety personnel. During this time the director or staff member will alert the school of "lock down" or use the pre-selected code over the intercom. Staff will account for all the children during this time and not allow anyone to leave. Teachers and students may not exit until an all clear signal is given. Teachers and students may evacuate the building if orders are given by the director or public safety personnel. At this point the teacher and students will relocate to designated relocation facility. Once they have relocated and are safe from harm the children will be accounted for, assess any injuries and parents will be called to pick up their children.

25.8 INCIDENT/ACCIDENT REPORTS

Should your child be involved in an incident/accident during the course of the school day, a staff member will complete an Incident/Accident Report. The Incident/Accident Report will be reviewed by teacher and parent of time of child pick-up.

Parents or persons designated to act "in loco parentis" are required to sign any incident/accident reports from the day at pick-up. The classroom teacher will be able to briefly discuss the matter with you at pick-up. However, should you feel it necessary to have an in depth discussion or meeting, it is most appropriate to schedule the meeting for a later date because the teacher is responsible for supervising the remaining children in the classroom. A telephone conference may be scheduled for later in the day or for the next day at nap/rest time if the parent(s) is unable to meet at the center during the course of the day.

Should a person other than the parent or one designated to act "in loco parentis" pick-up the child, a parent or person designated to act "in loco parentis" must sign the Incident/Accident Report. Original reports are kept in the office files. Copies will be given as per parent request.

25.9 FOOD

Menus will be posted in the front lobby and copies will be available to parents when requested.

All meals are prepared on the premises which are inspected by local health officials. All inspections are posted in the cafeteria near the menus.

For the safety of your child, parents are required to provide notification, in the form of a doctor's note, of any allergies (food or otherwise), with instruction for treatment should a child have an allergic reaction. Please refer to the Health and Safety Policies contained herein for further information.

Parents are required to provide written notification of any food/dietary restrictions. (i.e. lactose intolerance,

vegetarian diets, wheat free/gluten free diets)

NexGen School for Early Life foundations never uses food as a punishment. Children will never be denied participation in lunch or snack time for behavior reasons.

Infant through 17 months old age groups:

Children enrolled in the infant through 17 months olds old classrooms must have all food items for consumption prepared and labeled each day the child is in attendance. This includes formula/breast milk bottles, baby food, snacks, and juice bottles. Be sure to prepare one more bottle than you think your child will consume in a day to assure that your child won't run out. Bottles must already have pre-measured water ready for preparing. Dry formula must be pre-measured in divided formula dispensers. Prepared bottles must be stored in the designated refrigerator and will be warmed in a water bath prior to feeding. No bottles will be micro waved. All bottles must be taken home by the parents each night to be washed. If parent chooses to leave breast milk, they must leave instructions on how it should be stored, thawed out, and what should be done with the milk at the end of the day. All bottles, serving spoons, bibs, bowls, formula dispensers, and pacifiers must be labeled with child's first and last initial.

BREASTFEEDING EDUCATION

Policies specify that, a compilation of breastfeeding education and support resources in the community is provided to parents.

Parents are required to complete a feeding schedule for their child on a weekly basis, or as the child's feeding requirements change. Staff will complete a daily chart for each child detailing for the parent what the child ate, when, and how much. Extra snacks may be brought in for infants through 17 months old. Please note special instructions for how you would like snacks to be given throughout the day.

Breastfeeding mothers are welcome to come to the center during the day to feed their child. Appropriate, private feeding locations will be made available. Please discuss your desire to come to the center to breastfeed your child with the classroom teacher.

Meal Times:

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations offers children breakfast from 7:40 A.M. through 8:45 A.M., a twenty-minute lunch scheduled during 10:45 A.M. through 11:45 A.M., and an afternoon snack at from 2:30 P.M. through 3:30 P.M. and 3:30 P.M. through 4:00, for after school students, and dinner 4:30pm through 5:15pm.

All meals are family style, with the children sitting at tables, to promote good manners, eating habits and socialization skills. Staff will encourage children to eat their main entrée first, followed by healthy snacks.

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations participates and is in good standing with Child and Adult Care Food Program and prepares meals using the USDA food Guidelines. Milk and a fruit or vegetable is served at each meal. If your child is not allowed to drink milk, please fill out the necessary paperwork as discussed in the Health and Safety section of this handbook. We highly encourage all children to eat the meals provided by the school. Children may occasionally bring a sack lunch from home, but it is not recommended to do so regularly.

Liquid & Food Temperature:

1. Liquids and food hotter than 110 degrees F are kept out of reach
2. All staff are educated on food allergies and they take precautions to ensure children are protected.
3. On days that providers serve meals, prepared food that is brought into the program to be shared among children is commercially prepared or prepared in a kitchen that is inspected by local health officials.
4. That healthy snacks (as listed by the Texas Department of Agriculture) are Available for school

- aged children as students arrive.
5. On days that providers serve meals, milk, fresh fruit and vegetables are available for children who bring lunch from home.

Home Lunch Practices

1. Policies/ procedures to ensure the safety of food brought from home, including refrigeration or other Means to maintain appropriate temperatures.
2. Programs have policies in place outlining strategies to educate children and their parents on nutrition.
3. Programs provide parents with information about foods that may cause allergic reaction.
4. Providers provide sample menus of healthful lunches for parents whose children bring food from home.

Parents are encouraged to provide meals with adequate nutritional value.

25.10 PEANUT ALLERGIC REACTIONS

Due to the extreme nature of allergic reactions to Peanuts and products containing peanuts in some children, it is extremely important for parents to notify as well as fill out form for Severe Allergies. Peanut allergies can be so severe that exposure to peanuts can result in an anaphylactic reaction. An allergic child can have a reaction from simply smelling peanuts on someone's breath, or touching peanut oil residue left on a counter top, not only from consuming peanuts or peanut products.

Parents are responsible for providing a list of foods to NexGen School for Early Life Foundations that contain or may contain peanuts and/or peanut products. It is extremely important to remember to read the label of every food item to see if it may contain peanuts and/or peanut products your child may be allergic to. Many foods which we do not think of as containing peanuts or peanut products have in fact been made in the same factories as peanut containing foods and are therefore considered to be contaminated. When reading the label look at not only the ingredients listed but for statements such as, "may contain traces of peanuts." For example, Plain Chocolate M & M's have this statement on the label.

Note: Peanuts are not from the NUT family. They are a legume. This is why cashews and pistachios (and other items in the NUT family) are permitted.

25.11 FIREARMS AND WEAPONS

At no time is any person permitted to carry any type of Firearm, Ammunitions and/or Weapon on agency property for any reason. Violation of this policy will result in immediate dismissal from the program.

25.12 ACCOMMODATIONS FOR INDIVIDUAL NEEDS

Our program supports families and children who may need additional accommodations, to include home language, special needs/differing abilities, religion, and/or cultural backgrounds.

We allow parents to hire third-party therapist specialists and utilize our facility by allowing therapists access to classrooms for treatment. Sensory items that therapists may need will be provided by our facility on a request basis.

Our program also provides optional praise and worship in the mornings to accommodate religious following for those children who wish to participate, or if the parent requires it.

Children with a disability or limiting condition requiring special care will need a written evaluation on file. This evaluation will consist of medical and developmental examinations, assessment of cognitive functioning, health and social history, and an educational plan.

25.13 WATER ACTIVITIES

NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will not allow water activities for our students in which children share contained water (i.e. swimming pools). Water activities will be limited to sprinklers and other water games that do not involve contained water.

Parents will be notified in advance of any water days. Permission slips and appropriate attire will need to be provided in order for students to participate.

25.14 ANIMALS ON SCHOOL GROUNDS

Animals, including family pets, are not allowed on school grounds due to liability, health, safety, and sanitary issues.

25.15 "Gang Free Zone".

New Requirements Regarding Gang Free Zones for Child Care Center as a result of House Bill 2086 that during the 81 St. Legislative session, Resource Code includes section 42.064, effective September 01, 2009.

What is Gang –Free zone?

A Gang – Free zone is a designated area around a specific location where certain gang related activity is prohibited and is subject to increased penalty under Texas law.

Specific locations where certain gang related criminal activity is now prohibited include, but are not limited to, public schools, playground, video arcade facilities, and day care centers.

The area that falls within a gang- free zone can vary depending on the type of location. For example, certain Gang- related criminal activity that occurs within 300 feet of a video arcade facility is a violation of the new law,

Whereas certain gang- related criminal activity that occurs within 1000 ft. of a school or day care center is a violation of the law.

How do parents know where the gang – free zone ends?

The gang –free zone is within the 1000 ft. of your child care program. Maps may be produced for the purpose of prosecution and may be updated by the local municipal or county engineer. Parents may contact their local

Municipality to attempt to obtain a copy of the map if they choose to do so.

Why are Gang – Free Zone needed?

Similar to the motivation behind establishing drug-free zones, the goal of gang – free zones is to deter certain types of criminal activity in the areas where children gather by enforcing tougher penalties.

25.16 Physical Activities/Outdoor Play

State regulates that each child must be able to participate in outdoor activities each day if weather permits. The outside environment is filled with stimulating activities that will enhance your child's gross motor and social skills. Our outside environment is considered to be one of our classrooms, so all by enforced at all times.

POLICY: HEALTH & NUTRITION

POLICY NO.: 26

26.1 SCREEN TIME

Screen time activities for Children fewer than 2 years of age are prohibited. Children over 2 years of age will not exceed 2 hours per day, resources are available for parents.

26.2 VISION AND HEARING

Children enrolled must be screened by healthcare professional for possible vision and hearing problems at the age of 4. A screening record will be required in the child's file.

Families are provided with information about obtaining medical, dental, vision, and life insurance benefits. <https://www.texaschildrenhealthplan.org/benefits>

26.3 DENTAL

We offer dental informational meetings 2 times a year to encourage oral health with children and their parents. Our facility also posts resources on oral health on our family educational resources bulletin board located in the front office.

26.4 SOL CARE

Sol Care is a state food program that we've partnered with which provides us with healthy and nutritious foods for breakfast, lunch, snack, and supper. We prepare the meals using USDA food guidelines and is monitored through local health inspectors. The goal is to improve and maintain the health and nutritional status of children, promote the development of good eating habits, and integrate nutritional food service for adult and childcare.

Developmental Milestone Checklists & Child Progress Monitoring

At NexGen School for Early Life Foundations, we are committed to supporting each child's growth and development by using the Children Learning Institute checklist.

To ensure children are meeting age-appropriate milestones, our program uses developmental milestone checklists at least once per year for children ages 0–5. These checklists help us:

- Monitor developmental progress
- Identify potential developmental delays early
- Provide families with helpful information about their child's growth
- Make referrals for additional support when needed

Families will receive a copy of their child's completed checklist and are encouraged to discuss any questions or concerns with their child's teacher or administration.

If a child progress monitoring tool or more comprehensive assessment system is used in place of a checklist, it meets the same purpose of tracking developmental growth and ensuring children receive the support they need.

We believe early identification and strong family partnerships are key to helping every child thrive.

Early Childhood Intervention (ECI) Referrals

If a developmental concern is identified through milestone checklists, classroom observations, or parent input, NexGen School for Early Life Foundations may recommend a referral to Early Childhood Intervention (ECI) services in Texas. ECI is a statewide program that provides support and services for infants and toddlers (birth to 36 months) with developmental delays or disabilities.

With parent consent, we will assist families in connecting with their local ECI provider for a free evaluation. Participation in ECI services is voluntary, and families remain involved in all decisions regarding their child's care and support. Our goal is to partner with families to ensure children receive early support when needed so they can reach their fullest potential.

(current or former), for services which may conflict with operations at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations. Parents are strongly advised to refrain from soliciting any staff member for the purpose of employment. Parents who employ NexGen School for Early Life Foundations staff for services that conflict with the operations at NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will have their services terminated and any deposits will be forfeited. Staff who become employed by current or former clients of NexGen School for Early Life Foundations will have their employment with the NexGen School for Early Life Foundations terminated.

POLICY AGENCY CONTACT INFORMATION

POLICY NO: 29

NEXGEN SCHOOL FOR EARLY LIFE FOUNDATIONS TUITION FEES

POLICY NO: 30

Infants 4 months to 17 months:

Weekly Tuition: \$213.25/week

Daily Drop-in fee: \$45.00/day

Toddlers: 18 months to 24 months:

Weekly Tuition: \$203.36/week, Part time \$186.45

MWF or Half Day Tuition: \$122.00

Daily Drop-in fee: \$45.00/day

Two Year Old's: 24 months to 36 months:

Weekly Tuition: \$203.36/week, Part time \$186.45/week

MWF or Half Day Tuition: \$122.00/week, T/TH Tuition: \$81.34/week

Daily Drop-in fee: \$45.00/day

Three to Five Year Old's:

Weekly Tuition: \$196.10/week, Part time \$170.40/week

MWF or Half Day Tuition: \$117.00/week, T/TH Tuition: \$78.44/week

Daily Drop-In fee: \$45.00/day

Six to Twelve Year Old's:

Weekly Tuition: \$187.50/week, Part Time: \$162.90/week

Daily Drop-in fee: \$45.00/day

Transportation fee: \$100.00

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AND UPDATED IF NEEDED. LAST REVISED 02/26/2026**